Narmada, but now even in the South this began to change as Muslim women from all sections of society increasingly began to follow suit.

After Sayyid Alavi Mouladaveel Thangal's death in 1845 his only son, Sayyid Fazal Pookoya Thangal, returned to Malabar in 1849 after several years of self-imposed exile in Mecca, where the Wahhabis had recently been overthrown and dispersed by the Ottoman powers. He was seen by the British authorities as a 'fanatical ostentatious Wahabee of considerable influence', a view subsequently shared by a Saudi historian who has described him as 'highly influenced by the thoughts of Muhammad bin Abdul Wahhab' from his years in Mecca.[15] He now presented himself as the champion of the Mappila peasantry in their struggles against their Hindu landlords by issuing a fatwa that made it a religious duty for all Muslims to make jihad against their oppressors.



A watercolour showing three couples in the Madras Presidency, two Muslim and one Hindu. But which is which? The men can be identified by their style of dress but not the women. The man on the left holding a rose